

Maru Metall — 3-Minute Pitch Script

28DIGITAL Business Challenge 2026 · EIT Digital

Challenge: AI-Supported Cost Estimation Tool **Team format:** 4 speakers · CEO · COO · CFO · Commercial Lead

SLIDE 1 — CEO · 0:00–0:45 · THE PROBLEM

[Pause 2 seconds. Direct eye contact.]

Maru Metall receives **over 500 price inquiries every year.**

Each one arrives differently. Some are a conceptual sketch. Some are a full IFC model with thousands of pages of specifications. Some are a material list in Excel. Some are just an email with a PDF.

And for each one, an experienced cost engineer must sit down, read the documents, extract the quantities, estimate the fabrication hours, price the surface treatment, calculate the transport — and produce a quotation.

That process **takes hundreds of hours per inquiry.**

It depends entirely on the knowledge of one or two senior people. It is slow. It is expensive. It cannot scale.

And every hour spent quoting a project that Maru will not win is an hour not spent on the project it will.

This is the problem. Five hundred inquiries a year. One expensive manual process. Zero scalability.

SLIDE 2 — COO · 0:45–1:30 · THE SOLUTION

[Step forward. Clear and fast.]

We are proposing **SteelQuote AI** — an AI-supported cost estimation tool that turns any project documentation into a structured, traceable quotation that an experienced estimator can review, adjust, and send.

It works in four steps, which mirror the four tasks in the challenge:

Step 1 — Input Interpretation: The tool reads whatever it receives — IFC models, PDF drawings, BOM lists, email attachments, specification documents — and identifies the fabrication scope: what elements, what quantities, what complexity.

Step 2 — Quantity and Effort Extraction: From the interpreted input, SteelQuote AI extracts steel weights by element type, estimates fabrication labour using norm-based production logic, prices surface treatment by corrosion class, and calculates packaging and transport.

Step 3 — Risks and Assumptions: Every gap in the input becomes an explicit assumption or flag. Missing weld details? Assumed. Inconsistent drawing revisions? Flagged. Unclear

erection scope? Excluded and documented. The estimator sees every assumption before they sign off.

Step 4 — Output: A structured cost estimate: material, labour, surface treatment, transport — all traceable back to the source document or the assumption that generated each line.

Not a black box. Not a magic number. A **reviewable, adjustable quotation** in the format Maru already uses.

SLIDE 3 — CFO · 1:30–2:15 · THE NUMBERS

[Data-led. One clean slide.]

Let us put this in financial terms, using two real projects from the workspace.

Example 4 — Pedestrian Steel Skybridge:

Item	Value
Total project value	€591,285
Steel weight	206,414 kg
Unit price range	€2.46–€4.77 / kg

Example 2 — Akkasater Storage Hall:

Item	Value
Total project value	€333,395
Steel weight	148,315 kg
Unit price range	€1.74–€3.31 / kg

The pricing variation between elements is significant. Columns are priced differently from bracings. HDG elements are priced differently from painted ones. CNC-cut profiles are priced differently from manual cuts.

A skilled estimator knows these distinctions. The tool must encode them.

The business case is straightforward: If SteelQuote AI can handle even 40% of the 500 annual inquiries with minimal human review time, Maru recovers hundreds of engineering hours per year — and gains the capacity to quote more projects and win more contracts.

At the current cost of a senior estimator, **the payback is under one project.**

SLIDE 4 — Commercial Lead · 2:15–3:00 · PROOF OF CONCEPT & CLOSE

[Fast. Decisive. Results-forward.]

We are not proposing a finished product. The challenge asks for a **proof of concept** to support a go/no-go decision.

Here is what the PoC does:

It takes the **BOM from Example 4 — the Pedestrian Skybridge** — as the input. It reads the material list, classifies each element type, applies the norm-based labour model from the cost estimation principles provided by Maru, prices the surface treatment at the correct corrosion class, and generates a structured cost output.

We then compare that output against the **actual Maru quotation** for the same project. The delta between AI output and real quotation is the accuracy metric.

The PoC also handles **variable input quality**: it degrades gracefully when information is missing, making assumptions explicit rather than silently breaking.

The three success criteria are: 1. Output that an experienced estimator can review in minutes rather than hours. 2. Every cost driver traceable to its source or stated assumption. 3. Correct response to incomplete or inconsistent input.

[Final beat.]

Maru does not need to replace its estimators. It needs to **multiply their capacity**.

SteelQuote AI is the layer that turns 500 inquiries from a bottleneck into a competitive advantage.

Thank you.

TIMING GUIDE

Segment	Speaker	Time	Duration
Problem	CEO	0:00–0:45	45 s
Solution	COO	0:45–1:30	45 s
Numbers	CFO	1:30–2:15	45 s
PoC + Close	Commercial Lead	2:15–3:00	45 s

DELIVERY NOTES

- CEO must land “500 inquiries, hundreds of hours” as the central pain hook. Do not rush it.
- COO should recite the four steps with a rhythm — brief pause between each step name and description.
- CFO should have the two project tables on screen. The unit price variation row is the key insight.
- Commercial Lead ends on a positive, forward-looking note. “Multiply their capacity” is the closing line.
- The two-second opening pause is mandatory. Do not skip it.